



Why does metal get rusty?

Only iron and metals that contain iron, such as steel, get rusty. Iron rusts when it comes into contact with water and air. This is because the water and oxygen in the air react with the iron. This reaction creates a new substance—the reddish-brown flakes of rust.

Rustless rubber

Bicycle tires will not rust because they are made of rubber. Rubber does not react with oxygen in the way that iron does.

Chain reaction

A bicycle chain is made of steel, so it will rust. You can prevent rust by putting oil on the chain, which helps to keep water off it.

Quick quiz



What kind of metal becomes rusty?



What are bicycle tires made of?



Which parts of a bicycle can rust?

